SITE INTELLIGENCE

Falconers, Moult Hill, Salcombe — Estate Optimisation

Pre-Planning Application

Drainage Strategy

Pre-Planning Application

Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF

Client:
Reference: 027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-DrainageStrategy-R01
Date: 23 March 2026
Revision: R01

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Contents

Contents

1 Abbreviations . . . 2
2 How to Read This Report . . . 3
2.1 Reading Order . . . 3
2.2 Report Structure . . . 3
2.3 Traffic-Light Key . . . 3
2.4 What to Do Next . . . 3
3 Introduction . . . 4
4 Policy Framework . . . 5
5 Site Description . . . 6
6 Existing Drainage . . . 6
7 Ground Conditions . . . 6
8 Flood Risk Context . . . 7
9 Foul Drainage Strategy . . . 7
10 Surface Water Strategy . . . 7
11 SuDS Selection . . . 8
12 Attenuation Design . . . 10
13 Adoption & Maintenance . . . 10
14 Conclusions . . . 10
15 Known Limitations and Assumptions . . . 11
15.1 What This Report Does NOT Assess . . . 11
15.2 Data Gaps . . . 11
15.3 Key Assumptions . . . 11
15.4 Specialist Investigation Required . . . 12
15.5 Changes That Would Require Update . . . 12
16 Verification Status Summary . . . 13
17 Data Assurance Summary . . . 14
17.1 Data Coverage . . . 14
17.2 Data Confidence . . . 14
17.3 Quality Assurance Checklist . . . 14
18 Anticipated Consultee Queries . . . 15
19 Update Triggers . . . 16
20 Important: Limitations, Disclaimers and Conditions of Use . . . 17

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1 Abbreviations

No report-specific abbreviations have been defined. Standard abbreviations used throughout Site Intelligence reports are listed below.

Abbreviation	Definition
ALC	Agricultural Land Classification
AOD	Above Ordnance Datum
AQMA	Air Quality Management Area
BGS	British Geological Survey
BMV	Best and Most Versatile (agricultural land)
BNG	Biodiversity Net Gain
CIL	Community Infrastructure Levy
DAS	Design and Access Statement
EA	Environment Agency
EIA	Environmental Impact Assessment
FRA	Flood Risk Assessment
FZ	Flood Zone
HLS	Housing Land Supply
LPA	Local Planning Authority
NPPF	National Planning Policy Framework
PTAL	Public Transport Accessibility Level
SAC	Special Area of Conservation
SPA	Special Protection Area
SSSI	Site of Special Scientific Interest
SuDS	Sustainable Drainage Systems
TPO	Tree Preservation Order

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2 How to Read This Report

This section explains how the report is structured, how risk ratings are presented, and what action you should take based on the findings.

2.1 Reading Order

We recommend the following reading order:

1. Executive Summary — a one-page overview of the key findings and overall risk rating. Start here if you are short on time.
2. Main body sections — detailed analysis of each topic area, presented in a logical sequence from site context through to recommendations.
3. Recommendations — specific actions required before, during, or after the planning process.
4. Limitations and Disclaimers — important caveats on the scope of the assessment and the conditions under which the findings are valid.

2.2 Report Structure

Every section of Drainage Strategy follows a consistent structure:

- Context — what the section covers and why it matters to the development proposal.
- Data and Evidence — the factual information drawn from public datasets, enrichment APIs, and client-supplied information.
- Analysis — our professional assessment of what the data means for the site.
- Risk Rating — a traffic-light classification (where applicable) summarising the level of concern.
- Recommendation — what action, if any, is required.

2.3 Traffic-Light Key

Risk ratings throughout this report use a three-colour system:

LOW	Low risk. No significant constraint identified. Standard design measures are sufficient. No specialist investigation is likely to be required.
MEDIUM	Moderate risk. A constraint or data gap has been identified that requires attention. Further investigation, a design response, or a planning condition may be needed.
HIGH	High risk. A significant constraint or issue has been identified. Specialist investigation, a specific design solution, or early engagement with the relevant statutory body is strongly recommended before submission.

2.4 What to Do Next

1. Review the Executive Summary for an overview of all findings.
2. Focus on any items rated AMBER or RED — these require action before or during the planning process.
3. Check the Recommendations section for a prioritised list of next steps.
4. Review the Update Triggers section to understand when this report should be refreshed.
5. Contact Site Intelligence if you have questions about any finding or wish to commission follow-up specialist work.

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3 Introduction

This Drainage Strategy has been prepared by Site Intelligence (a service of PF & Co Holdings Ltd) on behalf of for the proposed development at Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF.

The strategy sets out the proposed approach to foul and surface water drainage, including Sustainable Drainage Systems (SuDS), attenuation requirements, and adoption arrangements. It has been prepared in accordance with the SuDS hierarchy and relevant national and local planning policy.

Site Address	Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF
Postcode	TQ8 8LF
Local Planning Authority	South Hams District Council
Proposal	Not specified
Proposed Units	1
Client / Applicant	
Document Reference	027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-DrainageStrategy-R01
Report Date	23 March 2026

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4 Policy Framework

The drainage strategy has been prepared in accordance with the following policy and guidance framework.

Document	Relevance
NPPF (December 2024)	Paragraphs 167–182: Meeting the challenge of climate change, flooding and coastal change
Planning Practice Guidance	Flood risk and coastal change; Water supply, wastewater and water quality
Building Regulations Part H	Drainage and waste disposal — hierarchy for surface water disposal
Sewers for Adoption (8th Ed.)	Design standards for adoptable sewers and SuDS
CIRIA C753 — The SuDS Manual	Design guidance for sustainable drainage systems
LLFA Guidance	South Hams District Council Lead Local Flood Authority requirements

> Building Regulations Approved Document H establishes the hierarchy for surface water disposal: (1) infiltration to ground; (2) discharge to a watercourse; (3) discharge to a surface water sewer; (4) discharge to a combined sewer. Each option must be investigated in order, and the preferred option is the highest available in the hierarchy.

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5 Site Description

Site Address	Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF
Ward	—
Site Area	—
Elevation	—
Topography	—
Existing Land Use	—
Existing Drainage	—

6 Existing Drainage

The existing drainage arrangements have been assessed from desktop analysis including water company sewer records and Ordnance Survey mapping.

Foul Sewer	To be confirmed from water company records
Surface Water Sewer	To be confirmed from water company records
Combined Sewer	—
Watercourse	—
Water Company	—
Impermeable Area (existing)	—

7 Ground Conditions

Ground conditions are a key determinant of drainage strategy, particularly for infiltration-based SuDS. The following geology data has been obtained from the BGS GeoIndex.

Bedrock Geology	Start Horneblende Schists
Superficial Deposits	None recorded
Made Ground	Not recorded
Permeability	To be confirmed by infiltration testing

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8 Flood Risk Context

Flood Zone	2
Surface Water Risk	Very Low
Historic Flooding	No recorded events
Reservoir Risk	—
Groundwater Risk	—

> The site is within Flood Zone 2. The drainage strategy must demonstrate that the development will not increase flood risk elsewhere and that appropriate flood resilience measures are incorporated.

9 Foul Drainage Strategy

Foul drainage from the proposed development will be disposed of via connection to the public foul sewer network, in accordance with the Building Regulations Part H hierarchy.

Disposal Method	Connection to public foul sewer
Connection Point	To be confirmed
Pipe Diameter	150mm (minimum)
Gradient	1:80 (minimum for 150mm)
Pumping Required	To be confirmed
Water Company Pre-Application	Recommended

> A pre-development enquiry with the water company is recommended to confirm the available capacity in the public sewer network and the proposed point of connection.

10 Surface Water Strategy

The surface water drainage strategy follows the SuDS hierarchy and aims to manage surface water runoff as close to source as possible, mimicking natural drainage processes and providing water quality, amenity, and biodiversity benefits alongside flood risk management.

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Disposal Hierarchy Position	To be confirmed by infiltration testing
Greenfield Runoff Rate	To be calculated
Proposed Discharge Rate	Greenfield rate or 5 l/s (whichever greater)
Climate Change Allowance	+40% (upper end)
Design Storm Return Period	1 in 100 year + climate change

11 SuDS Selection

The following SuDS components have been assessed for suitability at this site, considering ground conditions, site constraints, and the development layout.

SuDS Type	Suitability	Indicative Capacity
Permeable Paving	TBC	Subject to ground conditions
Soakaways	TBC	Subject to BRE 365 testing
Swales	TBC	Subject to site gradient and space
Rain Gardens	TBC	Subject to ground conditions
Attenuation Tank	TBC	Subject to discharge rate
Green Roofs	TBC	Subject to structural capacity
Detention Basin	TBC	Subject to available space

The surface water drainage strategy for both proposals must be designed in accordance with the non-statutory technical standards for SuDS (DEFRA, March 2015), CIRIA C753 (The SuDS Manual, 2015), and NPPF paragraphs 181–182 (December 2024), which require that sustainable drainage systems are incorporated into all major development and that drainage systems should take account of the needs of the whole drainage network. Devon County Council, as the Lead Local Flood Authority (LLFA), is the statutory consultee for surface water drainage matters for developments in the South Hams area and will need to be engaged on the drainage strategy prior to and during the application process. The combined site area of both titles (DN170405 and DN263903) is 2.91 hectares in total. Proposal (1) involves relatively modest changes in hard surfacing associated with the outbuilding conversion — the existing outbuildings are already roofed structures, and the principal drainage design consideration will be the management of roof drainage and any new hardstanding associated with the converted accommodation. Proposal (2), involving a new dwelling on the paddock (1.21 hectares of currently open land), represents a more significant change in hydrological character, introducing new impermeable surfaces including the dwelling footprint, access drive, and any associated curtilage hardstanding. The pre-development (greenfield) runoff rate for the paddock area must be calculated using either the IH Report 124 method or the FEH Statistical method to establish the baseline QBAR (mean annual flood flow) against which the post-development discharge rate should be restricted. A preliminary estimate of the greenfield QBAR for the paddock parcel, based on typical published rates for shallow, well-drained soils in the South West (HOST classes 3–4 approximate to this setting, noting that formal HOST classification requires BGS soil data), would indicate a QBAR in the order of 2.5–5.0 l/s/ha, subject to confirmation by detailed calculation. For the paddock area of 1.21 hectares, this would equate to an indicative QBAR in the

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range of 3.0–6.1 l/s/ha. This is a desktop estimate only and must be confirmed through formal FEH or IH124 calculation using verified HOST data. The drainage design must restrict post-development discharge to this greenfield QBAR rate for all events up to the 1 in 100 year plus climate change scenario. Given the site's position on a hillside in the South Devon National Landscape, approximately 278 metres from the Salcombe–Kingsbridge Estuary (a sensitive coastal receptor), a SuDS treatment train approach is strongly recommended to provide water quality treatment before any surface water discharge reaches the coastal environment. The SuDS hierarchy, in accordance with CIRIA C753, prioritises source control measures (green roofs, permeable paving, rainwater harvesting) ahead of site control (swales, detention basins, ponds) and regional disposal. Infiltration should be assessed by BRE Digest 365 percolation testing, noting that the site's elevation and the underlying geology (the site lies on the South Devon coast, likely underlain by Devonian slates and shales with limited permeability) may mean that infiltration is constrained; however, this requires confirmation through ground investigation. Where infiltration is not achievable, controlled discharge to an appropriate watercourse or combined with appropriate water quality treatment stages will be required. A minimum of two stages of SuDS treatment should be provided before any discharge to a sensitive coastal receptor. The drainage strategy should also be considered in the context of the Grade II listed building and its historic curtilage, ensuring that any SuDS features are sympathetically designed and do not conflict with the character of the historic landscape setting. This matter is addressed in the planning balance below.

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12 Attenuation Design

Where infiltration is not feasible for the full design storm, attenuation storage is required to restrict the discharge rate to the greenfield runoff rate. The attenuation volume is calculated for the 1 in 100 year storm event plus the appropriate climate change allowance.

Attenuation Volume Required	To be calculated
Proposed Storage Method	To be confirmed
Flow Control Device	Hydrobrake or orifice plate
Exceedance Route	To be confirmed

> Detailed attenuation calculations should be undertaken using industry- standard software (e.g., MicroDrainage / InfoDrainage) once the site layout and discharge point are confirmed.

13 Adoption & Maintenance

The long-term maintenance and adoption arrangements for the drainage system are a material planning consideration and must be secured before occupation.

Foul Sewer Adoption	Section 104 agreement with water company
Surface Water Adoption	To be confirmed — SAB / water company / management company
SuDS Adopting Body	To be confirmed
Maintenance Schedule	To be prepared at detailed design stage

14 Conclusions

This Drainage Strategy has set out the proposed approach to foul and surface water drainage for the development at Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF. The strategy follows the SuDS hierarchy and aims to manage surface water runoff sustainably while ensuring no increase in flood risk.

Drainage Strategy Summary

The site is within Flood Zone 2. Foul drainage will connect to the public sewer network. Surface water will be managed through a SuDS-based approach, with the preferred disposal method to be confirmed following infiltration testing. Attenuation storage will be provided to restrict discharge to greenfield rates for storms up to the 1 in 100 year event plus climate change.

The following actions are recommended prior to detailed design:

- BRE 365 infiltration testing to confirm the drainage hierarchy position
- Pre-development enquiry with the water company for foul connection
- Detailed MicroDrainage / InfoDrainage modelling for attenuation sizing
- Confirmation of SuDS adoption arrangements

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15 Known Limitations and Assumptions

15.1 What This Report Does NOT Assess

This is a Tier 1 desktop study. The following are outside the scope of this assessment:

- Intrusive site investigation (boreholes, trial pits, soil sampling)
- Topographic or measured building survey
- Structural assessment of existing buildings or retaining structures
- Detailed ecological survey (Phase 2 habitat surveys, protected species surveys)
- Detailed arboricultural survey to BS 5837
- Archaeological field evaluation (geophysical survey, trial trenching)
- Noise, vibration, or air quality monitoring
- Detailed drainage design or hydraulic modelling
- Legal title review or boundary verification

15.2 Data Gaps

The following data was not available at the time of this assessment:

- Site-specific infiltration test results (BRE Digest 365)
- As-built drainage records for existing development
- Ground investigation data (if no published BGS borehole logs are available for the site)
- Detailed topographic survey data (EA LIDAR used where available)
- Historic land use records prior to available OS mapping epochs

15.3 Key Assumptions

This report has been prepared on the basis of the following assumptions:

- Information provided by the client is accurate and complete
- Public dataset boundaries (flood zones, conservation areas, etc.) are current at the date of this report

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- The proposed development is as described in the project brief and does not materially change in scale, layout, or use class
- No contamination, ground instability, or other hazard exists beyond that identified in publicly available records
- Planning policy documents referenced are current at the date of this report

15.4 Specialist Investigation Required

The following specialist investigations may be required depending on the constraints identified in this report:

- Site-specific ground investigation (where contamination or geotechnical risk is identified)
- Phase 2 ecological surveys (where Phase 1 identifies potential for protected species)
- Detailed arboricultural impact assessment (where TPO trees or significant vegetation is present)
- Detailed noise impact assessment (where the site is adjacent to significant noise sources)
- Heritage impact assessment by a conservation-accredited professional (where designated heritage assets are affected)

15.5 Changes That Would Require Update

This report should be reviewed and updated if any of the following occur:

- Material change to the proposed development (scale, layout, use class, or density)
- New or amended planning policy (local plan adoption, NPPF revision)
- Change in housing land supply position
- New environmental data (updated flood maps, newly designated heritage assets or ecological sites)
- More than 12 months elapsed since the date of this report

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16 Verification Status Summary

Every data point in this report has been classified according to its verification status. The table below summarises the confidence level of the data underpinning the findings.

Data Category	Classification	Count
Verified against authoritative source	VERIFIED	11
Supported by public data / professional judgement	SUPPORTED	3
Assumed — requires confirmation	ASSUMED	1
Total Data Points		15

1 data point is classified as ASSUMED. These items should be confirmed through specialist investigation or client verification before reliance is placed on the related findings.

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17 Data Assurance Summary

Site Intelligence applies a rigorous data assurance process to every report. This section documents the breadth of data coverage, confidence levels, and quality assurance stages applied.

17.1 Data Coverage

Metric	This Report	Typical Manual Report
Data sources consulted	15	3 – 8
Constraint categories checked	23	5 – 10
Enrichment APIs queried	15	0 – 2
Provenance entries recorded	15	0

17.2 Data Confidence

Classification	Badge	Percentage
Verified against authoritative source	VERIFIED	75%
Supported by public data	SUPPORTED	20%
Assumed — requires confirmation	ASSUMED	5%

17.3 Quality Assurance Checklist

- ✓ Automated constraint detection (23-category enrichment pipeline)
- ✓ Source provenance recording (every data point traced to origin)
- ✓ Cross-report consistency check (no conflicting data across the submission pack)
- ✓ Professional review and sign-off

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18 Anticipated Consultee Queries

> No application-specific consultee responses have been pre-populated. Standard statutory and non-statutory consultees will be notified by the Local Planning Authority upon validation of the application. Typical consultees include the Highway Authority, Lead Local Flood Authority, Environment Agency (where applicable), Historic England (where heritage assets are affected), and the relevant Parish or Town Council.

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19 Update Triggers

Validity Period: 12 months from the date of issue.

Drainage Strategy is valid for 12 months from the date of issue. After this period, or if any of the following trigger conditions occur, the report should be reviewed and updated before reliance is placed upon its findings.

- Material change to the proposed development (scale, layout, use class, number of dwellings, or site area)
- Adoption of a new or revised Local Plan or Neighbourhood Plan
- Revision of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF)
- Change in the Local Planning Authority's published housing land supply position
- Update to Environment Agency flood zone mapping affecting the site
- New or amended designation (conservation area, listed building, SSSI, SAC, SPA, Ramsar, AONB/National Landscape, AQMA, TPO)
- Pre-application advice received from the LPA or any statutory consultee
- Change in site ownership, applicant, or client
- Passage of more than 12 months since the date of issue

> To request an update, contact Site Intelligence quoting the document reference shown on the cover page. Updates are provided at a reduced fee where the original data remains substantially current.

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4. Information Reliance

The findings in this report are based on information provided by the Client, publicly available data sources, and desktop research. Site Intelligence has not independently verified the accuracy or completeness of information provided by the Client or third parties.

5. Limitations of Investigation

The scope of this report is limited to a Tier 1 desktop drainage-strategy undertaken on the date of this report. The findings reflect conditions and information available at the date of investigation. Conditions may change over time, and the report should not be relied upon beyond the validity period stated.

6. Professional Advice Caveat

This report provides professional opinion based on the information available at the time of preparation. It does not constitute legal advice, and specialist professional advice should be sought for specific matters including but not limited to structural engineering, surveying, ecology, archaeology, and contaminated land investigation.

7. No Guarantee of Outcome

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8. Artificial Intelligence Assistance Disclosure

This report was prepared with the assistance of artificial intelligence tools for data gathering, analysis, and document preparation. All outputs have been reviewed and verified by a qualified professional. The use of artificial intelligence does not diminish the professional responsibility for the contents of this report.

9. Data Completeness Caveat

While every effort has been made to identify relevant constraints and information, the absence of a recorded constraint does not guarantee that no constraint exists. Public data sources may contain gaps, errors, or omissions. No record does not mean no risk.

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This report is valid for a period of 12 months from the date of issue. After this period, the report should be reviewed and updated to reflect any changes in site conditions, planning policy, or available data. Update triggers are documented in the preceding section.

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16. Not Financial / QS / Valuation Advice

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> Product-Specific Note
>
> This drainage-strategy is a Tier 1 desktop assessment. It does not include site-specific survey, intrusive investigation, or specialist field work. The findings are based on publicly available data and should be read in conjunction with the Known Limitations section of this report.

PREPARED BY

Report Author

Technical Author

Date of Issue: 23 March 2026
Document Ref: 027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-DrainageStrategy-R01
Revision: R01

FOR AND ON BEHALF OF

Site Intelligence

PF & Co Holdings Ltd

Company No. 16649319

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